

Spatial ML - class 3 - obtaining information from the environment

Total points 100/100 ?

Email *

o.marvan@student.uw.edu.pl

Student index: *

477001

Name: *

Ondřej



Surname: *

Marvan
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1. What does a spatial weights matrix W primarily define? *

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- ☒ The pattern of spatial relationships between units
- ☐ The magnitude of spatial autocorrelation
- ☐ The distribution of the dependent variable
- ☐ The strength of regression coefficients

2. In a queen contiguity matrix, two regions are neighbours when they: *

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- ☐ Are within a fixed distance threshold
- ☐ Share a border
- ☒ Share a border or a corner
- ☐ Belong to the same administrative level



3. After standardization of matrix (style = "W"), which property holds?

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- ☐ The matrix becomes symmetric
- ☐ Each column sums to one
- ☐ All weights become identical
- ☒ Each row sums to one

4. If a region has 4 neighbours in a row-standardised matrix, each neighbour receives weight:

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- ☒ 0.25
- ☐ 1
- ☐ Depends on the neighbour's value
- ☐ 4



5. The spatial lag represents: *

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- ☐ The variance of neighbouring observations
- ☐ The difference from the global mean
- ☒ The weighted average of neighbouring values
- ☐ The sum of all neighbouring values

6. Which statement about KNN matrices is correct? *

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- ☐ They are always symmetric
- ☒ Each unit initially has exactly k neighbours
- ☐ They guarantee a connected network
- ☐ They automatically sum to one by row



7. Why can different spatial weights matrices lead to different model results?***10/10**

- ☐ Because spatial data are random
- ☐ Because regression ignores spatial structure
- ☒ Because W encodes assumptions about interaction
- ☐ Because the spatial lag is constant

8. Fragmentation in a spatial weights matrix refers to: ***10/10**

- ☐ Very large weight values
- ☐ Units connected to all others
- ☒ Units with no neighbours
- ☐ Presence of negative autocorrelation



9. Inverse distance matrices can be computationally demanding because they are often: *10/10

- ☐ Symmetric by construction
- ☐ Based only on polygon data
- ☐ Sparse and highly diagonal
- ☒ Dense with many non-zero entries

10. Radial zoning is particularly useful for point data because: 10/10

- ☐ Points naturally share borders
- ☒ Interactions are typically local and continuous
- ☐ It guarantees matrix symmetry
- ☐ It eliminates spatial dependence

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